

Time Management (CPM/PERT) - Key Terms Glossary

SECTION: Critical Path

The longest path through a project network diagram, determining the shortest possible project duration.

SECTION: Float (Total Slack)

The amount of time an activity can be delayed without delaying the overall project finish date.

SECTION: Free Float

The amount of time an activity can be delayed without delaying the early start of any successor activity.

SECTION: Lead

A relationship that allows a successor activity to start before its predecessor finishes, accelerating the schedule.

SECTION: Lag

A forced delay inserted between a predecessor's finish and a successor's start, such as waiting for concrete to cure.

SECTION: PERT (Program Evaluation and Review Technique)

A technique using optimistic, most likely, and pessimistic duration estimates to calculate an expected activity duration under uncertainty.

SECTION: Forward Pass

A network diagram calculation that determines the early start and early finish of each activity.

SECTION: Backward Pass

A network diagram calculation, starting from the project end date, that determines the late start and late finish of each activity.

SECTION: Crashing

A schedule compression technique that adds resources to critical path activities to shorten duration, usually at increased cost.

SECTION: Fast-Tracking

A schedule compression technique that performs normally sequential activities in parallel, increasing the risk of rework.